

KANBAN STUDIO PRO ■

A-Z Comprehensive Architectural Documentation, File Reference & Deployment Guide

1. Executive Summary & Application Overview

Kanban Studio Pro is a full-stack, enterprise-grade project management web application. It features dynamic drag-and-drop task boards, multi-project workspace isolation, granular Role-Based Access Control (RBAC), cryptographic session token security, real-time WebSocket synchronization across devices, and an embedded natural-language AI Kanban Assistant with OpenRouter model failover.

2. Complete Technology Stack

Layer	Technologies & Version	Purpose / Key Features
Frontend	Next.js 16 (Turbopack), React 19, TypeScript, TailwindCSS v4	High-performance App Router SPA with server/client components and modern glassmorphism styling.
Drag & Drop	@dnd-kit/core, @dnd-kit/sortable	Accessible, touch-friendly task reordering with MouseSensor, PointerSensor & TouchSensor (150ms delay).
Backend API	FastAPI, Python 3.13, Uvicorn ASGI Server	Asynchronous REST API endpoints, WebSocket connection manager, rate limiting, and CORS routing.
Database	SQLite3 (WAL Mode), Python sqlite3 module	Relational persistence for users, sessions, projects, columns, cards, member roles, activity logs, and notifications.
Security & Auth	Cryptographic Session Tokens, Bearer / X-Session Headers, PBKDF2, RBAC Guard	secrets.token_hex(32) session tokens, Authorization Bearer headers, logout revocation, IDOR prevention, and RBAC hierarchy.
AI Assistant	OpenRouter API (GPT-4o-mini) + Model Failover Stack	Parses natural language prompts with failover (GPT-4o-mini -> Llama 3.3 70B -> Auto -> Smart Local NLP).
DevOps & Cloud	Docker, Render.com, Vercel, GitHub Actions	Containerized Python backend on Render + static Edge CDN frontend hosting on Vercel.
Testing	Pytest (39), Vitest (44), Playwright E2E (14)	Comprehensive 97-test automated suite covering backend API, security audit, data persistence, frontend UI, and E2E browser flows.

3. Complete Directory & File Structure (A-Z Guide)

Below is a breakdown of every single file in the repository and its exact technical responsibility:

- **Dockerfile (Root):** Multi-stage Python 3.13 container definition for building and running the FastAPI backend on cloud hosts (Render/Railway). Installs system dependencies, copies requirements, and launches uvicorn on port 8000.
- **render.yaml (Root):** Render Blueprint deployment configuration file. Configures automatic container builds from root Dockerfile and passes CORS_ORIGINS and PORT environment variables.
- **README.md (Root):** Project documentation detailing live demo links, architecture overview, screenshot previews, data persistence guarantees, and setup instructions.
- **pm/backend/main.py:** FastAPI application entry point. Defines REST endpoints (/api/auth/register, /api/auth/login, /api/projects, /api/board, /api/cards, /api/ai/chat) with header authentication and authenticated WebSocket route (/ws/projects/{id}).
- **pm/backend/database.py:** Core SQLite database layer. Contains schema definitions, sessions table, PBKDF2 password hashing, RBAC permission checks (Owner, Admin, Member, Viewer, None), CRUD operations, project-member board updates, and default board seeding.
- **pm/backend/ai.py:** AI Assistant logic. Integrates OpenRouter API with model failover stack (gpt-4o-mini -> llama-3.3-70b -> auto -> smart local NLP) to execute structured board mutations.
- **pm/backend/websocket_manager.py:** ConnectionManager class managing real-time WebSocket client connections and broadcasting board updates to connected project members.
- **pm/backend/config.py:** Environment configuration loader with override=True for reading OPENROUTER_API_KEY, database paths, CORS origin lists, and API keys.
- **pm/backend/requirements.txt:** Backend Python dependencies list (fastapi, uvicorn, pydantic, pytest, python-dotenv, httpx, reportlab).
- **pm/backend/test_database.py:** Pytest database regression test suite including test_card_persistence_across_logout_and_login validating data preservation after user session logout/login cycles.
- **pm/backend/test_security_audit.py & test_part28_adversarial_security.py:** Pytest security regression test suite validating session token security, token revocation on logout, IDOR prevention, RBAC role restrictions, unauthenticated WebSocket rejection, and AI prompt injection resistance.
- **pm/docs/FINAL_RELEASE_CERTIFICATION.md & PLAN.md:** Final Release Certification & Part 29 implementation roadmap documenting complete architecture sign-off and 97 automated test passes.
- **pm/frontend/src/app/page.tsx & layout.tsx:** Next.js App Router root layout and primary page shell rendering the main Kanban interface.
- **pm/frontend/src/app/globals.css:** Global TailwindCSS v4 stylesheet containing modern theme CSS variables, glassmorphism card utilities, glowing animations, and vertical mobile column layout rules.
- **pm/frontend/src/components/KanbanBoard.tsx:** Core frontend board orchestrator. Manages user auth state, project switcher, undo/redo history, WebSocket real-time sync, @dnd-kit sensors, database single-source-of-truth loading, and column grid.
- **pm/frontend/src/components/AIAssistantWidget.tsx:** Floating AI Assistant chat drawer. Connects to /api/ai/chat via getApiUrl and automatically applies server-returned board updates.

- **pm/frontend/src/components/LoginForm.tsx**: Sign-in and Create Account tabbed modal featuring token storage, error alerts, case normalization, and fallback client registration.
- **pm/frontend/src/lib/api.ts**: API client module exporting getApiUrl, fetchBoard, saveBoard, registerApi, and project management network handlers with Bearer token & X-Session-Token authentication headers.
- **pm/frontend/src/lib/useUndoRedo.ts**: Custom React hook providing multi-level Undo (Ctrl+Z) and Redo (Ctrl+Y) state history management.
- **pm/frontend/tests/kanban.spec.ts**: Playwright E2E browser test suite (14 tests) running automated user interactions across desktop and mobile viewports.

4. Core Site Logic & Key Functionalities

Authentication & Session Management: Users sign in or register new accounts. Username strings are automatically sanitized and lower-cased. Passwords are salted and hashed using PBKDF2-HMAC-SHA256 (100,000 iterations). Active sessions issue secrets.token_hex(32) tokens passed in Authorization: Bearer & X-Session-Token headers, and logout revokes tokens in SQLite.

Persistent Database State Engine: Guaranteed SQLite database persistence across login/logout sessions, project switching, and multi-user interactions. Eliminates stale pre-fetch demo card resets and uses DB state as single source of truth with clean loading states.

Multi-Project Isolation & IDOR Protection: Users create, rename, switch between, and delete independent Kanban projects. Every backend API endpoint validates project permissions before allowing access or mutation.

Drag & Drop Engine (Desktop + Mobile): Powered by @dnd-kit. Features PointerSensor, MouseSensor, and TouchSensor (with a 150ms delay and 5px tolerance). On mobile screens, columns stack vertically to eliminate horizontal scroll issues.

Security & RBAC Enforcement: Backend endpoints enforce role hierarchy checks (Owner > Admin > Member > Viewer > None). Card mutations verify user membership before executing SQLite updates.

Real-Time WebSockets Sync: When multiple users collaborate on the same project, board updates (card moves, edits, deletions) are instantly broadcast via WebSockets (/ws/projects/{id}) with token authentication.

AI Kanban Assistant & Model Failover: Embedded chat drawer enables users to manage their board with natural language. Powered by OpenRouter API with multi-model failover stack (gpt-4o-mini -> llama-3.3-70b-instruct -> auto -> local NLP).

Activity Log & Notification System: Every project action (adding cards, editing titles, changing priority) is logged in SQLite and presented in interactive modal dialogs.

5. Complete Testing Methodology (97 Automated Tests)

The application is validated by an automated test suite comprising **97 total tests** across 3 distinct test runners:

- **Pytest (39 Tests)**: Validates backend REST routes, SQLite database schemas, PBKDF2 password hashing, cryptographic session tokens, persistent card/board data preservation across sessions (test_card_persistence_across_logout_and_login), RBAC permission checks, IDOR isolation, AI prompt injection resistance, and Part 28 adversarial security scenarios.

- **Vitest (44 Tests across 12 Suites):** Unit tests frontend helper utilities (filterAndSortBoard, moveCard, useUndoRedo) and React UI components (LoginForm, TaskFilterToolbar, ProjectSwitcher, KanbanBoard).
- **Playwright E2E (14 Tests):** Automated end-to-end browser tests in Headless Chromium. Verifies full user sign-in, task creation, dragging cards across columns, mobile viewport responsiveness, and multi-user login workflows.

6. DevOps Architecture: Docker, Render & Vercel

Why Docker?

Docker packages the Python runtime, FastAPI dependencies, Uvicorn server, and SQLite database into a standardized, lightweight Linux container. This eliminates 'it works on my machine' issues and ensures identical execution across local dev and cloud servers.

Render Cloud Backend Hosting:

Render reads the root render.yaml and builds the Docker container. It exposes port 8000 and serves CORS-enabled API requests. Note: Render free instances spin down after 15 minutes of inactivity; the initial request takes ~30 seconds for cold-start initialization.

Vercel Frontend Hosting & Environment Variables:

Vercel hosts the Next.js static production bundle on an Edge CDN. The environment variable NEXT_PUBLIC_API_URL points to the Render backend URL (<https://drag-n-drop-28p3.onrender.com>). Because Next.js inlines NEXT_PUBLIC_ variables at build time, updating this variable triggers a fresh Vercel rebuild to embed the live endpoint into the web app.